4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which products and services are growing?

Period: March 2026. Revenue, gross margin and growth (year on year) by product or service line over 24 months. Pick a line and every number, chart and note follows it.

How final is this data?

March 2026 Locked March 2026 is locked (closed 2 Apr 2026). These numbers won't change.

Trades

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit

March's jobs made $90,236 gross margin (42.2%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $23,895 and overheads $59,200, leaving $7,141 profit before tax (3.3% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 38.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$90,236
Technician wages and on-costs	$79,587
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$55,692
Technician time not charged to jobs	$23,895
Gross profit (the P&L)	$66,341
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,200
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$7,141
Revenue	$213,578
Gross margin on jobs, %	42.2%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.3%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**38.9%**

Line: All

March against March last year
41.9%
$213,578 against $150,465

Year to date (Jul to Mar 2026)
$1,611,390
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
43.6%
$702,138 before overheads

What it shows

Revenue is $1,611,390 this financial year to date (Jul to Mar 2026). Maintenance contracts make the highest gross margin (63.8%); Installations the lowest (35.4%). The business needs 38.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 35.4% gross margin, 0.4 points over the 35.0% target ($4,113 ahead on $1,015,900 this financial year to date). Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($102,682 ahead on $356,000 this financial year to date).

Line: Maintenance contracts

March against March last year
34.2%
$42,000 against $31,300

Year to date (Jul to Mar 2026)
$356,000
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
63.8%
$227,282 before overheads

What it shows
Maintenance contracts brought in $356,000 this financial year to date, at a 63.8% gross margin (above the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Maintenance contracts: 63.8% gross margin, 28.8 points over the 35.0% target ($102,682 ahead on $356,000 this financial year to date).

Line: Installations

March against March last year
50.3%
$144,900 against $96,400

Year to date (Jul to Mar 2026)
$1,015,900
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
35.4%
$359,678 before overheads

What it shows
Installations brought in $1,015,900 this financial year to date, at a 35.4% gross margin (below the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Installations: 35.4% gross margin, 0.4 points over the 35.0% target ($4,113 ahead on $1,015,900 this financial year to date).

Line: Call-outs and repairs

March against March last year
17.2%
$26,678 against $22,765

Year to date (Jul to Mar 2026)
$239,490
same period last year: not in the data

Gross margin, year to date
48.1%
$115,178 before overheads

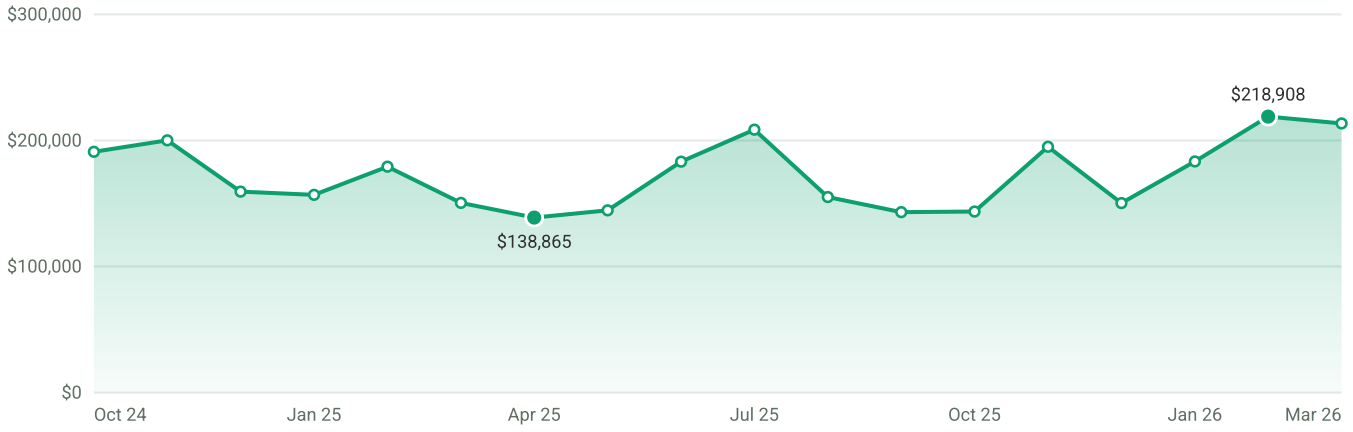
What it shows
Call-outs and repairs brought in $239,490 this financial year to date, at a 48.1% gross margin (above the 43.6% overall).

What you'd do about it
Call-outs and repairs: 48.1% gross margin, 13.1 points over the 35.0% target ($31,357 ahead on $239,490 this financial year to date).

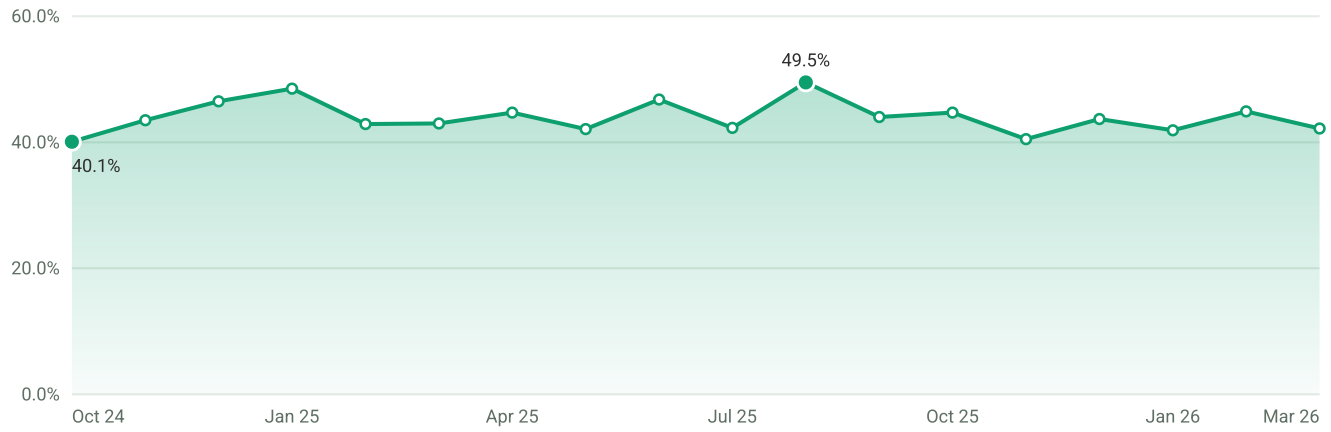
Every line at once

Revenue, gross margin and growth by line, by month

All · Revenue $



All · Gross margin %



Growth is year on year: each month against the same month a year earlier. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

By line: financial year to date (Jul to Mar 2026) against the same period last year

	Year to date	Same period last year	Growth	Gross margin $	Gross margin %
Maintenance contracts	$356,000	–	–	$227,282	63.8%
Installations	$1,015,900	–	–	$359,678	35.4%
Call-outs and repairs	$239,490	–	–	$115,178	48.1%
Total	$1,611,390	–	–	$702,138	43.6%

Same period last year: Not available: the data starts October 2024.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.